What’s In the Original 1987 Program Files

A plain list of what’s actually in the program’s files, group by group. For each group, here’s what we believe it is. Where we’re not sure, we say so in one short line, not a long explanation.

The eight industry versions

Every version (there are eight, one letter each: A, B, C, D, M, R, S, T) has the same four files: one holds the questionnaire, one holds written risk and fit-checking text, one calculates the scores and builds the report, and one holds the underlying calculation formulas. That’s the same pattern repeated eight times.

A separate small file names which letter is which industry. Our reading of it: A = Large Manufacturing, B = Large Service, C = Large Retail, D = Large Restaurant, M = Manufacturing, R = Retail, S = Service, T = Restaurant. We could be wrong about this — it’s our read of one file, not confirmed against your own memory of the system.

The program launchers

Four files (named GPATHOR1 through GPATHOR4) plus two small companion files look like how the whole program was packaged and started up. As far as we can tell, they don’t contain any additional content beyond the eight versions above — just the startup/packaging layer.

The Client Service Planning files

A separate group of six files forms a standalone program whose own title screen calls it the “Client Service Planning System.” Its own instructions say it’s for a consultant to fill out about a client, across six topics: Development Stage, Strategy, Structure, Culture, Leadership Style, and Client Relationship. We think that sixth topic, Client Relationship, is actually about the consultant’s own way of building trust with the client — different from the other five, which are about the client’s organization.

The multi-rater comparison files

Three files contain what looks like a real, dated 1992 report comparing eight different people's ratings of the same organization, showing where they agreed and where they didn't.

The fit-checking write-ups

Inside each version's risk file (mentioned above) there's a large amount of written text — not just scores, but explanations of when certain combinations of answers don't fit well together, what a "healthy" versus "unhealthy" organization looks like on about thirty specific items, and a description of what each growth stage's ideal way of being organized looks like. This is real, complete, written content — the same kind of thing in each of the eight versions.

Individual client and consultant files

About twenty small files, each named with a consultant's or client's initials, look like real saved assessments from actual past work — specific people's actual results, not general content.

The stage chart file

One file appears to describe the chart showing how an organization moves between growth stages over time, including named points where one stage turns into another.

A couple of empty files

Two very small files appear to be leftover, empty print-output placeholders with nothing in them.

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One thing we specifically checked and didn’t find

We looked across every file above for anything related to nonprofit organizations — a different letter, a different name, anything. We didn’t find it. If a nonprofit version exists, it isn’t present in this set of files.

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